

TẬP I

Session 13

Instructor: Hồ Lê Vũ



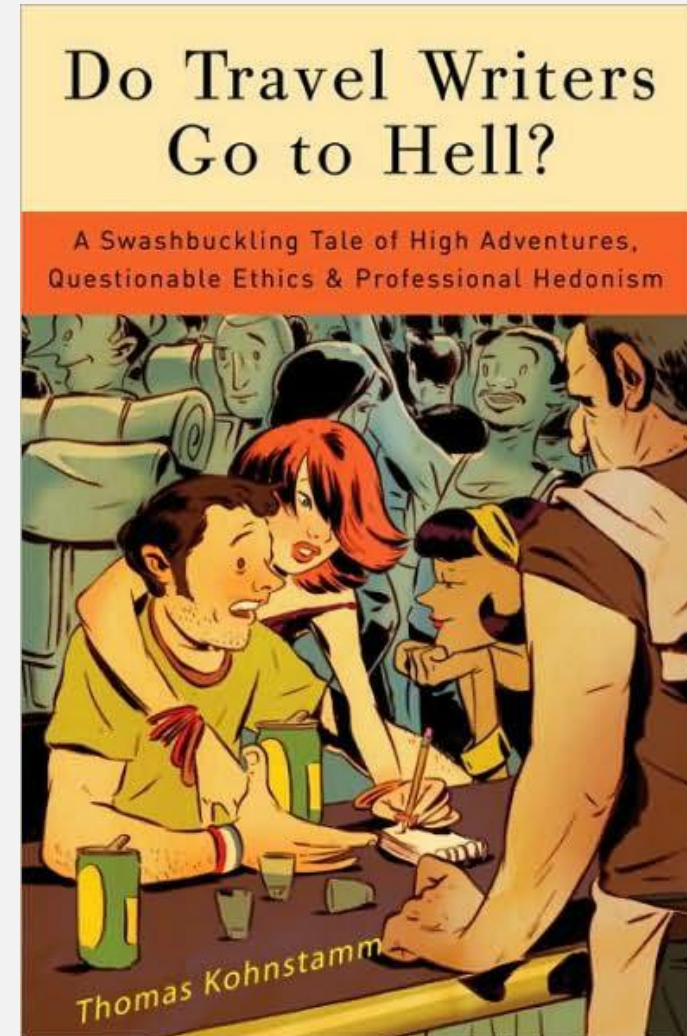
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OVERVIEW

- TRAVEL

Slide No 4

- Reading: Can you trust your travel guidebook (cont.)



TEXT

Kohnstamm trades Wall Street drudgery for a **gig** gathering information for a Lonely Planet guidebook about Brazil. Almost as soon as he touches down in Brazil, he finds himself **in a fix**. He was given 60 days to cover a 1,000-mile section of northern Brazil for the 2005 Lonely Planet guide for that country. As he explains the job, you are supposed to go everywhere and provide flawless information, **right down to** the phone numbers of bars up the Amazon, and do so on a **skinflint's budget**.

STRUCTURES

- a **gig** [I] gathering information for a Lonely Planet guidebook
- [magnitude] **gig** [I→N] < **show** [N] < **concert** [N→F]
 - The band cancelled their next three **shows** due to illness.
 - **Gig** usually indicates a smaller venue, e.g., pubs and clubs, whereas **concert** would be used for bigger shows at arenas and stadiums.
- **chạy sô?**

STRUCTURES

- [magnitude] gig [I→N] < show [N] < concert [N→F]
 - chạy sô?
 - Vietnamese pop stars often play multiple gigs in various venues every night
- vs. The coronavirus crisis has highlighted the vulnerability of the gig economy.
- gig workers vs. freelancer

STRUCTURES

- He finds himself **in a fix**
- **trouble** [N] vs. **fix** [I] vs. **predicament** [F]
 - The sailing boat is **in serious trouble** against very strong winds.
 - The ESL teachers with fake IELTS certificates got themselves **in a fix**.
 - If you had told the truth in the first place, we wouldn't be **in this predicament**.
- **bóc phốt?**

STRUCTURES

- bóc phốt?
 - It took internal **whistle-blowing** [J] and investigative journalism to uncover the rot.
 - The law must be changed to protect **whistle-blowers** [J]

STRUCTURES

- right down to the phone numbers of bars up the Amazon
 - All the staff are friendly from the manager right down to the cleaners.
 - I was a soldier down to my shoelaces.

STRUCTURES

- do so on a **skinflint's budget**
- **meager** [N] vs. **skinflint's** [I] vs. **exiguous** [F] budget
 - Jack's **meager budget** does not allow him to take a vacation each year.
 - The price was adjusted to accommodate an **exiguous budget**.
- **đồng lương bèo bọt, bữa ăn đạm bạc**
 - a **meager** meal | a **meager** salary

TEXT

So, Kohnstamm was forced to do a "**mosaic job**," relying in some cases on information from local contacts, fellow travelers and the Internet. **Short on cash** and running up against his deadline, he is **reduced to** lurking outside cafés reading menu boards and **jotting notes** on what he sees on people's plates. Worse still, he does a little **drug dealing** to **pay his way**, until he discovers the secret of meeting a deadline: many of his predecessors in the travel guide racket have **faked their way** around the globe, using other guides as their sources. "*What I can't plagiarize, I can always make up,*" he decides.

STRUCTURES

- Kohnstamm was forced to do a **mosaic job**.
 - An unconnected **piecemeal** | **patchwork** system of laws prevent the land from being developed.
- *PVO?*



STRUCTURES

- Short on cash and running up against his deadline
- short on cash [N] vs. cash-strapped [I, J] vs. lacking sufficient fund [N→F]
 - Cash-strapped consumers have gone deeper into debt.
 - These cities are lacking sufficient fund to maintain their free services to lower income people.

STRUCTURES

- he is reduced to lurking outside cafés reading menu boards
- hạ mình đi ăn xin?
 - The former manager was reduced to begging on the street.
- tòa nhà biến thành đồng gạch vụn?
 - The building was reduced to rubble by the explosion.

STRUCTURES

- jotting notes on what he sees on people's plates
- scribble [N] vs. jot down [I→N]
 - Keep a pad handy to jot down questions as they occur.
 - She scribbled a note to tell Mum she'd gone out.

vs. Ben took notes in shorthand.

- chữ viết như gà bới?

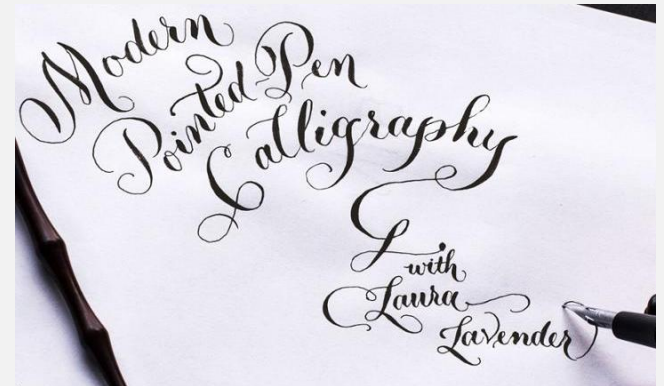
STRUCTURES

- chữ viết như gà bới?
 - I can't read your **chicken scratch**! What does this say?
- cuộc thi vở sạch chữ đẹp?

STRUCTURES

- cuộc thi vở sạch chữ đẹp?
 - Student **handwriting** [N] vs. **penmanship** [F] vs. **calligraphy** [ART] contest

**Chinese
penmanship**



STRUCTURES

- He does a little drug dealing to pay his way
 - Many of his predecessors have faked their way around the globe
- chen vào đám đông?
 - She pushed her way into the crowd.

FUN ACTIVITY

- Watch the second part of a Trans-Vietnam adventure by three British guys.

Kohnstamm's revelations have prompted other guidebook writers to **speak out**. Jeanne Oliver, a former Lonely Planet writer **based in** Nice, France, recently ripped the company for shifting from a **royalty model**, in which the writer's income is based on book sales, to a **work-for-hire deal**, with the writers getting a one-time fee covering both expenses and payment. Oliver says Kohnstamm's revelations were "a car crash that was **waiting to happen**" because of Lonely Planet's "wrongheaded" policies on compensation and royalties. "For most authors, most of the time, LP are not paying enough to properly write and research a book. And they haven't for a number of years now. They are begging authors to **cut corners** somehow, somewhere or, on the other hand, to help finance the book **out of their own pocket**. It takes very, very few authors running around cutting deals for themselves to ruin this company's reputation. As we now see."

STRUCTURES

- prompted other guidebook writers to **speak out**.
- **state** [N] vs. **speak out** [I→N, ON] vs. **voice** [F] one's opinion
 - He has already **stated** his intention to run for election.
 - He was the only one to **speak out against** the decision.
 - Human rights groups have **voiced** their concern over the treatment of refugees.

STRUCTURES

- a Lonely Planet writer **based in** Nice
 - a full service construction company **based in** the UK
 - = Both companies are **headquartered in** Seattle.
- **phóng viên thường trú** tại...?
 - (a reporter) **based in** | *location-based*

STRUCTURES

- shifting from a **royalty model** to a **work-for-hire** deal
 - **Work-for-hire** refers to the situations in which a creator of a work does not **retain the rights to** that work.
- a car crash that was **waiting to happen**
 - = I think it's a disaster **in the making**

STRUCTURES

- They are begging authors to **cut corners**

[literal] I tried to **take a shortcut** and got lost.

- There's a worn patch on the grass because everyone **cuts the corner**.

[figurative] The food is bad because the chefs are asked to **cut corners** [ON] on ingredient quality.

- Sometimes in our haste we **take shortcuts** [N] that we later regret.

STRUCTURES

- to help finance the book out of their own pocket.
vs. pocket money [BR] = allowance [AM]

TEXT

Reid Bramblett, author of several Frommer's guides, says: "*Over the past decade, just about every professional travel writer I know who once did guidebooks, either full time or as just **one cog in the wheel** of their freelance career, has gotten out of the game.*" Bramblett said a publisher recently offered him \$3,100 for a job that he estimated would cost him \$9,500 in expenses. "*I would have been spending \$6,400 of my own money for the privilege of writing their guidebook.*"

STRUCTURES

- just about every professional travel writer I know
 - almost [N] vs. just about [I] vs. virtually [A]
 - Storms have been hitting almost all of Britain recently.
 - We've won three games while missing virtually a whole team.
- who did guidebooks as just one cog in the wheel [I] of their career
 - We are all but a cog in the machine [I], looking to become a larger cog.

QUIZZ

- Cấu trúc nào học ngày hôm nay có thể dùng để dịch **CẢ** hai cụm từ sau đây? (**chỉ được phép một đáp án**)
 - Anh ta chẳng học hành gì, mà chỉ lo ăn chơi trong suốt những năm học đại học.
 - Phụ huynh cúng tiền cho trường để con em có thể vào trường điểm.

QUIZZ SOLUTIONS

- to **party** one's **way** through college
- They **bought** their **way** into a top school.
- **chẳng học hành gì, toàn ngủ nướng mà vẫn tốt nghiệp?**
 - **sleep** one's **way** through collegevs. The new department chief **slept her way** to her current position.
- **vừa học vừa làm để trang trải tiền học đại học?**
 - **work** one's **way** through college

TEXT

*I am a **kept man** for as long as I stay in Canoa. I enjoy free drinks at the bar in town that evening, and **on a whim** walk over to the neighboring sushi joint to get an idea of the menu and see if I can **swing** a free sampling. The waitress suggests that I come back after she closes down the restaurant, around midnight. We can talk more then. I don't eat any sushi, but we end up having sex in a chair and then on one of the tables in the back corner of the restaurant. I pen an observation in my notebook that I will later recount in the guidebook review, saying that the restaurant “is a pleasant surprise... and the table service is friendly.”*

TEXT

Before I am able to approach anyone, I am cornered by an apparently inebriated French girl. *“I heard that you write for Lonely Planet,”* she says in accented but impeccable English, teetering backward. *“Really? From whom?”* *“I heard it around.”* *“OK. Maybe it's true.”* Is this my chance at my first French groupie? *“You know what?”* she hiccups. *“No, what?”* *“I was traveling with some friends. We split up for a few weeks, but made plans to meet up at a bar in Salvador on a specific date. We picked the bar out of the Lonely Planet. It was highly recommended. When I got there, I found out that it closed down. Many years ago. Somebody told me that it has been closed for almost ten years. I have not seen my friends since. You ruined my trip, Mister F*cking Lonely Planet,”* she shouts, staggering back against the people sitting at the table behind her. At least a dozen people are staring at the two of us. **So much for** being inconspicuous.

STRUCTURES

- I am a **kept man** for as long as I stay in Canoa.
 - A **kept woman** is maintained in a comfortable lifestyle by a wealthy man so that she will be available for his sexual pleasure.
 - **kept woman** [O, H] → **kept man** [H]
- to see if I can **swing** a free sampling.
 - **manage** [N] vs. **swing** [I] vs. **procure** [F]
 - Over the last year the company has **managed** a 10 per cent improvement.
 - She asked him to **procure** visas for her family.
 - It remained very difficult to **procure** a loan.

STRUCTURES

- At least a dozen people are staring at the two of us. **So much for** [S, ON] being inconspicuous.
 - Another rise in income tax. **So much for** all those election promises. → *watch sample clips*
 - It's weird you not being **within shouting distance**
 - **within** hearing | walking | driving **distance**
 - vs. a restaurant **within spitting distance** of the Tower of London.
- **You're just saying that.** → *PVO?*

TEXT

*The research, particularly the restaurant research, is much easier when everything is networked and prearranged. The owner of a hotel will put you in touch with the owner of a restaurant, and once things are **in motion** it is **no time** before you end up with a full schedule of lunch and dinner plans, menu samplings and free cocktails. I **get to** meet the managers, chefs, and owners; tour the kitchens; and chat with some of the guests. A pizza restaurant that is closed for the **low season** is opened and the wood oven is fired up so that I may give their food a try. Some of the owners try to badmouth other establishments or steer you away from them, so it is important not to take everything they say **at face value**. You smile, you speak ambiguously, you show that you are thankful (but never overly impressed), and, most important, you accept their assistance without making any promises. A big part of the job is learning who you can trust and who you can use but never trust. Yes, I accept freebies, but that only helps to make the research possible. I swear that I would never write something untrue about a place, simply because they gave me a free room or a plate of pasta.*

TEXT

Distilling a Brazilian bus station into a 250-word transportation table is **alchemy at best**. There is no making sense of some of them. If I were to come up with a set schedule for the guidebook, I'd basically be making it up, lying to fit Lonely Planet's standards. And that's exactly what I end up doing. I use a lot of estimating, averaging, and faux-authoritative decision making. How many buses a day from Fortaleza to Aracati. Twenty? Twenty-five? Forty-five? Who knows? Who gives a f*ck? They come all the time.

TEXT

*I write from my experience. I write from my research. I write from my imagination. I write about hotels and restaurants and towns that I never visited. I write about hotels and restaurants and towns that I feel guilty about not visiting. I write about hotels and restaurants and towns that I never visited and **could care less** about. I write about nudist beaches, recipes for traditional salted meats, anaconda mating habits, and the two-inch-long candiru catfish that swims up your urethra (the requisite Amazonian horror story that every travel writer must **pen** about Brazil). I write about things that I learn about as I am **putting them down** on the page. I write about things that I still don't understand, even after I've written about them.*

STRUCTURES

- once things are **in motion**
- **underway** [N] vs. **in motion** [N→F] vs. **in progress** [F]
 - An investigation is **underway** to find out how the disaster happened.
 - The wheels of change have been set **in motion**.
 - The road will be closed while the maintenance work is **in progress**.

→ *watch sample clips*

STRUCTURES

→ *watch sample clips*

- There occurred a **game-changing** emergency.
 - The coach admitted Steven's goal three minutes before the break was a **game-changer**.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

- [diminutive] mini-vomit [l, H] vs. minibus [N]



STRUCTURES

- it is **no time** before you end up with a full schedule
 - We'll figure out a solution **in next to no time**.
- I **get to** meet the managers, chefs, and owners.
- **have** a/the **opportunity** [N] vs. **get** [I] vs. **have** an/the **occasion** [N→F] to do something
 - You'll **have the opportunity** to ask questions at the end.
 - Her brothers went out a lot, but Lisa never **got to** go.
 - I was in Brighton, so I **had an occasion** to visit him.
- **khi có cơ hội?**

STRUCTURES

- khi có cơ hội?
- if/when the opportunity presents itself [N] vs. someone gets a/the chance [I→N] vs. the occasion arises [N→F]
 - Definitely will go again if I get the chance.
 - As soon as the opportunity presents itself, she would get another job.
 - I'll speak to him about it when the occasion arises.
 - [mix and match] if the opportunity arises | if the occasion presents itself

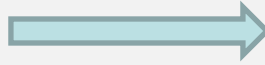
Slide No 43 FOOD FOR THOUGHT

- chance vs. opportunity

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

CHANCE

risk



OPPORTUNITY

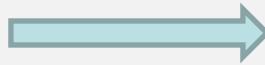
advantage

- A **chance** is something you take. An **opportunity** is something you get.
- You can take a **chance** on getting through the traffic light while it's still yellow; or can you stop and take the **opportunity** to kiss your girlfriend.
- Having lost your job, you take a **chance** on buying lottery tickets every day or you take the **opportunity** to travel around the world.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

CHANCE

risk

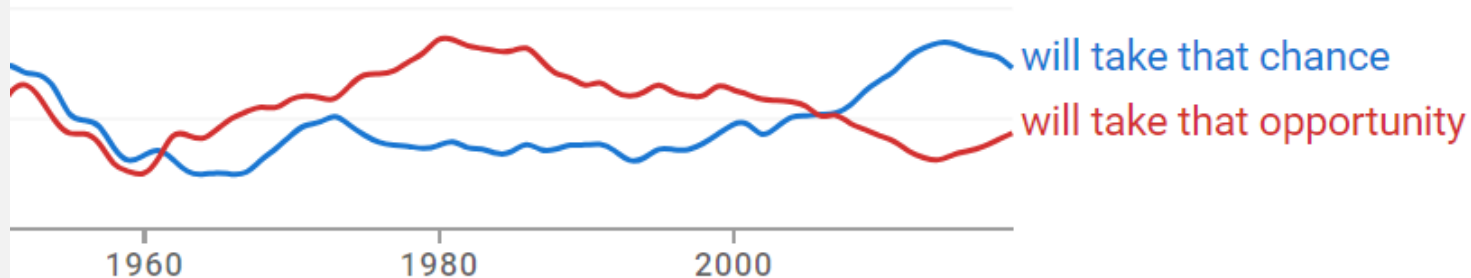


OPPORTUNITY

advantage

Interchangeable usage in real life
(involving **synecdoche**)

- Are you really going to give up your job and audition for American Idol?
- Yes. I will take that **chance** vs. **opportunity**.



STRUCTURES

- The pizza restaurant is closed for the low season.
 - low | off season vs. high | peak season vs. mid | shoulder season [TOURISM]
- It is important *not* to take everything they say at face value.
 - ý ở mặt chữ?
 - take the words at their face value

STRUCTURES

- Distilling a Brazilian bus station into a 250-word transportation table is **alchemy at best**.
 - The funds were distributed quickly and, **as if by alchemy** [L], turned into roads by the individual states.
- có sức người sỏi đá cũng thành cơm?

STRUCTURES

- Distilling a Brazilian bus station into a 250-word transportation table is **alchemy at best**.
 - có sức người sỏi đá cũng thành cơm?
 - The **alchemy [L]** of hard work can turn soil into sustenance [F].
 - These aren't top-quality gems; the clarity is so-so **at best [ON]**.
 - His chances of victory are, **at best [ON]**, uncertain.
- vs. You'll love their new album. It's simply jazz **at its best [OP]**.

STRUCTURES

- the requisite Amazonian horror story that every travel writer must **pen** about Brazil
 - **write** [N] vs. **compose** [F] vs. **pen** [L]
vs. I **write** about things that I learn about as I am **putting** them **down** [I→N] on the page.
- **khai bút đầu xuân**?
- to **pen** (the first entry of the new year)

STRUCTURES

- write [N] vs. compose [F] vs. pen [L]

vs. read [N] vs. peruse [F]

vs. There is more to reading than taking in [I→N] the words on a given page. Reading is about connecting those words to the real world to give them meaning.

- She found the information while she was perusing a copy of Life magazine.

STRUCTURES

- I write about towns I never visited and **could care less** about.
 - **could care less** vs. **couldn't care less** → *sarcastic inversion*
 - We **couldn't care less** about the Royal Wedding.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

- Yeah, right | Yeah, sure.
- I'm good.
- Tell me about it
- You don't say [so]!
- Good luck with that! | You should be so lucky.
- More bad news? Just what I need! | That's perfect.

→ *watch sample clips*

– Give me some scratchers I'm feeling lucky.

- scratch-off card [N] vs. scratcher [I]

Slide No 53

- Extra reading: [Why I'll never return to Vietnam](#)



STRUCTURES

- There's **not enough money in the world** to get me to go back.
→ *PVO*?
- The cabbie **rigged his meter** on the way to the bus station.
 - **Rigging the vote** or ballot rigging is considered a serious electoral fraud.
 - **dàn xếp tỉ số?**

STRUCTURES

- The cabbie rigged his meter on the way to the bus station.
 - Rigging the vote is considered a serious electoral fraud.
 - dàn xếp tỉ số?
 - rig the match
 - cân gian?

STRUCTURES

- The cabbie rigged his meter on the way to the bus station.
 - Rigging the vote is considered a serious electoral fraud.
 - dàn xếp tỉ số?
 - rig the match
 - cân gian?
 - rig the scale
- PVO?

STRUCTURES

- The cabbie rigged his meter on the way to the bus station.
 - mua đường?

STRUCTURES

- The cabbie rigged his meter on the way to the bus station.
 - mua đường?
 - take a longer route | make a detour [to run up the meter]
 - taxi dù?

STRUCTURES

- The cabbie **rigged his meter** on the way to the bus station.
 - mua đường?
 - take a longer route | make a detour [to run up the meter]
 - taxi dù?
 - unregistered taxi

STRUCTURES

- I knew I was being blatantly **ripped off**.
 - **rip** someone **off** [I] vs. **be had** by someone [S]
 - I don't trust them. I think **we've been had** by those salesmen.
- rip off** $\ni$ **gouge** [I, AM]
 - A company that sold bottles of hand sanitizer must pay a \$1,900 fine for **price gouging**.
 - The airline has been accused of **gouging** their customers.

STRUCTURES

- Maybe I caught people on an off day.
 - "We just had an off day," he said after Saturday's 2-1 defeat.
 - Although this student failed the test, given her past excellent performances, this student most likely has just had an "off" day.

STRUCTURES

- It seemed my experience was the norm and not the exception.
- vs. [IELTS tips] an exception rather than the norm
- Marriage with children becomes an exception rather than the norm as many couples just live together and bear children out of wedlock.

STRUCTURES

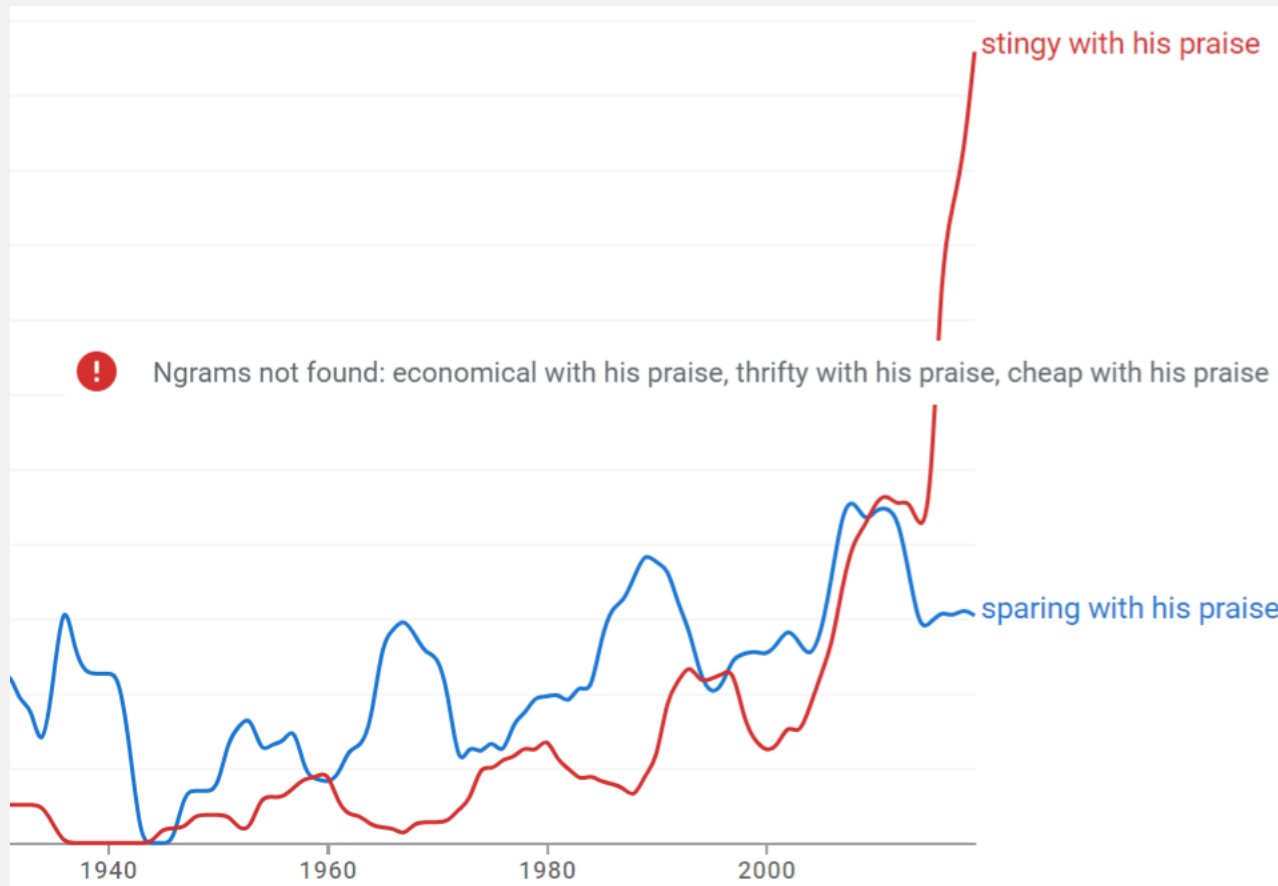
- When they see western backpackers trying to **penny pitch** [ON]
 - a **penny-pinching** [ON] bride whose wedding day cost less than the price of the average wedding dress
- [ON] **mean** [N, BR] vs. **stingy** [I] vs. **cheap** [I, AM] vs. **parsimonious** [F]
 - She was too **mean** to put the heating on.
 - The West is **stingy** with aid.
 - You are so **cheap** you won't even spend a few bucks for breakfast?
 - Britain, along with Germany, comes in the middle of the tipping league, neither **profligate** nor **parsimonious**.

STRUCTURES

- [ON] **mean** [N, BR] vs. **stingy** [I] vs. **cheap** [I, AM] vs. **parsimonious** [F]
- [OP] **frugal** | **thrifty** [N] vs. **economical** [N→F] vs. **provident** [F] vs. **budget-conscious** [PC]
 - **Frugal** people focus on getting the best value for their money while **cheap** folks only care about the lowest price.
 - **Thrifty** people make use of old items and repurpose them into something fabulous and new.
 - He is always **economical** when it comes to buying presents.
 - It is possible to be **provident** without being **parsimonious**.
 - summer vacation ideas for **budget-conscious** families
- *Fun question*: so you **cheap** or **budget-conscious**?

STRUCTURES

- Kiệm lời khen?
 - be **stingy with** [ON] vs. **sparing with** [N] one's praise or compliment



STRUCTURES

- [ON] **mean** [N, BR] vs. **stingy** [I] vs. **cheap** [I, AM] vs. **parsimonious** [F]
- [OP] **frugal** | **thrifty** [N] vs. **economical** [N→F] vs. **provident** [F] vs. **budget-conscious** [PC]
- **extravagant** [N] vs. **high-rolling** [I] vs. **profligate** of [F]
 - It would be too **extravagant** to go by taxi.
 - an entertainment complex that would attract **high-rolling** gambling tourists from Japan.
 - The opposition criticized the government's **profligate** spending plans.

FUN ACTIVITY

- Is this family cheap or frugal?

STRUCTURES

- I like the struggle. I think it builds character.
- I couldn't get out fast enough.
 - Spring can't get here quick | soon enough.
 - The days don't go slow enough. It's another late night. I don't know why or even how I stay up this late, so consistently.

HOMEWORK

- Session 13:
 - TRAVEL
 - SOCIOLOGY